



\$1

\$1 is the first command-line argument passed to the shell script. Also, known as Positional parameters. For example, \$0, \$1, \$3, \$4 and so on. If you run `./script.sh filename1 dir1`, then:

- `$0` is the name of the script itself (`script.sh`)
- `$1` is the first argument (`filename1`)
- `$2` is the second argument (`dir1`)
- `$9` is the ninth argument
- `${10}` is the tenth argument and must be enclosed in brackets after `$9`.
- `${11}` is the eleventh argument.

Contents [\[hide\]](#)

- 1 [What does \\$1 mean in Bash?](#)
 - 1.1 [\\$1 example](#)
- 2 [\\$1 in bash functions](#)
 - 2.1 [Examples](#)

What does \$1 mean in Bash?

These are positional arguments of the script. Let us see examples to clarify ideas.

\$1 example

Create a shell script named `demo-args.sh` as follows:

```
#!/bin/bash
script="$0"
first="$1"
second="$2"
tenth="${10}"
echo "The script name : $script"
echo "The first argument : $first"
echo "The second argument : $second"
echo "The tenth and eleventh argument : $tenth and ${11}"
```

Run it:

```
chmod +x demo-args.sh
./demo-args.sh foo bar one two a b c d e f z f z h
```

```
vivek@nixcraft-wks01 tmp$ chmod +x demo-args.sh
vivek@nixcraft-wks01 tmp$ ./demo-args.sh foo bar one two a b c d e f z f z h
The script name : ./demo-args.sh
The first argument : foo
The second argument : bar
The tenth and eleventh argument : f and z
vivek@nixcraft-wks01 tmp$
```

Sample outputs from `demo-args.sh` script

\$1 in bash functions

In bash functions, `$1` serves as the first bash function parameter and so on.

Examples

Create a new script called `func-args.sh`:

```
#!/bin/bash
die(){
    local m="$1" # the first arg
    local e=$2  # the second arg
    echo "$m"
    exit $e
}

# if not enough args displayed, display an error and die
[ $# -eq 0 ] && die "Usage: $0 filename" 1

# Rest of script goes here
echo "We can start working the script..."
```

Run it as follows:

```
chmod func-args.sh
./func-args.sh
```

Now try again:

```
./func-args.sh /etc/hosts
```

```
vivek@nixcraft-wks01 tmp$ ./func-args.sh
Usage: ./func-args.sh filename
vivek@nixcraft-wks01 tmp$ ./func-args.sh /etc/hosts
We can start working the script...
vivek@nixcraft-wks01 tmp$
vivek@nixcraft-wks01 tmp$
```



Another example:

```
fingerprints() {  
    local file="$1"  
    while read l; do  
        [[ -n $l && ${l###} = $1 ]] && ssh-keygen -l -f /dev/stdin <<<$l  
    done < $file  
}
```

See [Pass arguments into a function](#) for more information.

Category: [Bash Parameters](#)

Content is available under [Attribution-Noncommercial-Share Alike 3.0 Unported](#) unless otherwise noted.

[Privacy policy](#) [About Linux Shell Scripting Wiki](#) [Disclaimers](#) [Mobile view](#)

